Medication Storage and Handling Procedure

1. Purpose

This procedure describes how medicines are received, stored, and recorded at the clinic so that they stay safe and traceable. It applies to all pharmacy and nursing staff.

2. Receiving Deliveries

Every delivery must be checked against the purchase order on arrival. Staff confirm the product name, quantity, batch number, and expiry date. Items with damaged packaging or less than 6 months of remaining shelf life are rejected and reported to the pharmacy manager.

3. Storage Conditions

Most medicines are kept in the main pharmacy storeroom at room temperature, below 25 degrees Celsius. Items that require refrigeration are kept in the pharmacy fridge between 2 and 8 degrees Celsius.

Fridge temperatures are recorded twice a day, at the opening and closing of the clinic. If a reading falls outside the allowed range, the pharmacist on duty must be told immediately and the affected items are quarantined until reviewed.

4. Expiry Checks

A full stock check for expiry dates is carried out on the first working day of every month. Expired medicines are labelled, separated from active stock, and disposed of through the approved waste contractor. Disposal is logged in the disposal register.

5. Controlled Medicines

Controlled medicines are stored in a locked cabinet. Two authorised staff members must be present to count the stock at the start and end of each day, and both must sign the controlled register.

6. Incident Reporting

Any storage error, missing item, or suspected contamination must be reported on the incident form within 24 hours. The pharmacy manager reviews incidents every month and shares lessons learned with the team.